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Module 1

1.1 Entrepreneurs and Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneur:

- Someone who **identifies** and **acts** on an idea or **problem** that no one else has identified or acted on.
- A person who starts a business and is willing to risk loss to make money.

Key concepts from these definitions:

- Willing to take a risk
- Willing to risk loss
- Farsightedness and innovation

Two things entrepreneurs do:

- Recognize opportunity
- Create something new

Technopreneur:

- An entrepreneur who **leverages technology** as the foundation of their business.
- They are **innovative individuals** who combine **technical expertise** with **entrepreneurial skills** to create new products, services, or business models, often driving innovation and disruption within their industry.

More on Entrepreneurs and Entrepreneurship:

- What people consider an entrepreneur can vary — some strictly differentiate between entrepreneurs and small business owners, while others acknowledge that a person could be both.
- Essentially, an **entrepreneur** is someone who creates and runs a new business where one did not exist before.
- Entrepreneurship** is about risk, problem solving, and filling a gap where no one else is.
- An **entrepreneurial venture** is the creation of any business, organization, project, or operation of interest that includes a level of risk in acting on an opportunity that has not previously been established.
 - Can be for-profit or not-for-profit.
 - Entrepreneurs may approach their entrepreneurial venture as innovators,

creators, market makers, or expanders and scalers.

Key Entrepreneurial Roles:

Role	Description	Examples
Innovators	Companies known for introducing groundbreaking technologies or ideas that significantly change industries	OpenAI, Tesla
Creators	Design and develop entirely new platforms, products, or systems that create new markets or redefine existing ones	Meta (Facebook), Canva, Github
Market Makers	Establish entirely new markets or ecosystems	Shopify, Airbnb, Uber
Expanders and Scalers	Take existing technologies or business models and scale them to a global market	Netflix, Zoom, Spotify

Entrepreneurship as a journey:

- Entrepreneurship is an unusual journey — you've got to be certain it's how you want to live your life and what you want to use your life for.
- You and your business are inextricably linked. Your business derives its purpose from your purpose; your business derives its meaning from your life.

Reflection Questions:

- How do you define success?
- What is your personal definition of success?
- How would you define success for your venture idea?
- What kind of entrepreneur will you be?

1.2 The Entrepreneurial Lifestyle and Career

- Being an entrepreneur has become synonymous with being an **innovator**, a **change agent**, or a **risk taker**.
- The difference between risk and calculated risk is **due diligence** — conducting the

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necessary research and investigation to make informed decisions that minimize risk.

- To **minimize** personal **financial risk**, some startup entrepreneurs **continue with their current employment** while **working on the side** to **develop** their idea into a venture that eventually will generate an income.

Lifestyle Venture: a business in which the founders' primary focus is the **lifestyle** they will attain through **becoming entrepreneurs**, rather than a primary interest in financial rewards through selling the business.

- Within the entrepreneurial world, **harvesting** is the typical exit strategy. The **harvest** is the point at which the investors and entrepreneurial team receive their return on creating and building the venture.
- For a lifestyle venture, the entrepreneur is more likely to be a **solo entrepreneur** and funded through family/friends and more traditional methods, such as bank or small business loans.
- This lifestyle **includes greater freedom** to decide areas of responsibility, hours of contribution to the venture, and other decisions that support the desired lifestyle, enabling alignment of values, interests, and passions to create a balance.

1.3 The Entrepreneur as a Problem Solver

- We often have a tendency to jump quickly from **noticing a problem** to **selecting a solution**, with little understanding of whether we have even correctly identified the problem.
- **Identifying the problem** — and **testing** the **potential, novelty**, and **feasibility** of your solution — is an important part of resolving the problem.

Problems often have multiple causes:

- The need for something to be better, faster, or easier
- The effects of changes in the world on your industry, product, or service

- Market trends based on geography, demographics, or the psychology of the customers

Entrepreneurial problem-solving: the process of **using innovation** and **creative solutions** to resolve societal, business, or technological problems.

Problem-Solving Step-by-Step Approach:

1. **Identify the problem.** What needs to be fixed?
2. **Determine the root causes.** Once you have identified *what* your problem is, you need to figure out *why* it is.
3. **Find multiple solutions.** Think innovatively. Do not settle for the first solution you find. Find as many alternative solutions as you can.
4. **Determine the solution that will work best.** Go about it logically. Consider viability, scalability, available resources, risks, benefits, and how it can be measured.
5. **Plan and implement your solution.** Build a plan to execute your solution. You will need to cover who, what, when, and how you will implement your plan.
6. **Measure the success of your solution.** How does it measure against your goals, objectives, and budget? Can you see a measurable outcome?

Opportunity-Identification Perspective: one characteristic of a savvy entrepreneur is **recognizing the ability to identify a problem** from an opportunity-identification perspective — this means turning *how to solve a problem for one person* into *how to solve it for multiple people*.

- **Example:** We might identify feeling hungry as a problem. An entrepreneur would determine how the problem could be translated into an opportunity to create a new venture — perhaps addressing the problem of feeling hungry between meals with a street kiosk or a vending machine, or creating a new snack that is nutritious, satisfying, and portable.
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1.4 Factors Driving the Growth of Entrepreneurship

- Research shows that nearly **50 percent** of all **US employment** is at risk due to **artificial intelligence** and other technologies.
- Losing a job, being rejected or mistreated at work, or having your income reduced or benefits removed might be an impetus to start your own business.
- When we have our own business, we have **greater control** — in exchange, we also carry the **risk for all decisions** we make.
- This control over decision-making is one reason that some people find the world of entrepreneurship attractive.

More reasons why people become entrepreneurs:

- The **excitement** and **fun** of **creating** something **new** and moving the idea from concept to reality
- The combination of **having available time** and a **desire for continued earnings** encourages some older adults to explore entrepreneurial opportunities
- The **expanding awareness** and support of entrepreneurship as a **viable career choice**, and **moving away from** the older model of **employment** (i.e., long-term employment with a corporation)
- The **expanding opportunities** and **support for individuals** by communities and organizations that see how entrepreneurial ventures add economic development and enhancements worth supporting

1.5 Entrepreneurship Around the Globe Nations with Most Attractive Entrepreneurial Ventures (GDP vs. GEI):

Rank	Nation	Gross Domestic Product	GEI
1	United States	52,676	83.6
2	Switzerland	54,933	80.4
3	Canada	42,104	79.2

4	United Kingdom	37,451	77.8
5	Australia	42,149	75.5
6	Denmark	44,005	74.3
7	Iceland	34,541	74.2
8	Ireland	42,012	73.7
9	Sweden	45,533	73.1
10	France	37,948	68.5

Source: Infographic.ly Team, "Infographic: The Growth of Entrepreneurship Around the Globe," Entrepreneur Middle East, January 26, 2017.

Key takeaway: The **United States** leads the world in entrepreneurial ventures, with **Switzerland** not far behind.

What does it take to become an entrepreneur?
Besides an entrepreneurial mindset, it takes **education** and **funding**.

Three Primary Global Sources of Funding:

- **Family and friends**
 - Sometimes willing and able to invest money in the entrepreneurial team.
- **Angel investors**
 - Often **entrepreneurs** who have **successfully launched** and **harvested** their **own ventures** and have an **interest** in **helping other entrepreneurs** in their **startups**, staying active in the entrepreneurial world, and receiving a return on their investment. They often provide funding **early** in the life of a venture.
- **Venture capitalists (VCs)**
 - A **group** of people (or organizations) who **pool resources to invest** in **entrepreneurial ventures**, contributing **larger sums** than are available through **angel investors**. In each funding round, investors receive an equity stake in the venture with

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expectations that at some point in the future the venture will be sold or harvested, at which time investors receive a return on their investment.

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Venture Capital Activity (2015):

Region	2015 Investment	2015 Deals
United States	\$72.3 billion	3,916
China	\$49.2 billion	1,611
Europe	\$14.4 billion	1,598

- Tracking VC funding over time shows steady increases as entrepreneurial ventures have become more common.

Venture Capital Investment Summary: 2015 vs. 2024

Region	2015 Investment	2015 Deals	2024 Investment
United States	\$72.3 billion	3,916	\$209 billion
China	\$49.2 billion	1,611	\$5.8 billion (Q4 only)
Europe	\$14.4 billion	1,598	\$62.4 billion

- United States:** VC investment more than doubled since 2015, reaching **\$209 billion** in 2024. AI startups like **OpenAI, Databricks, and Anthropic** were **major contributors**. Despite fewer deals, the average deal size increased significantly.
- China:** Investment dropped sharply, with only **\$5.8 billion** recorded in Q4 2024 — reflecting a broader trend of **declining VC activity** due to **geopolitical** and **economic** challenges.
- Europe:** VC funding rose to **\$62.4 billion** in 2024, with notable growth in AI and biotech sectors. Europe **outpaced Asia-Pacific in Q4 2024**, marking a significant shift in global VC dynamics.

ASEAN Venture Capital Landscape (2025):

- Total VC Capital Raised:** US\$13.37 billion across ASEAN.
- Top Markets:** Singapore leads, followed by Indonesia and the Philippines.
- Key Sectors:**
 - Fintech:** Dominates VC activity, especially in wealthtech and cross-border payments.
 - E-commerce & SaaS:** Slower growth due to profitability pressures.
 - Emerging Verticals:** Deep tech, AI infrastructure, and life sciences are gaining traction.

Philippine Venture Capital Landscape (2025):

- Regional Share:** The Philippines now accounts for **19%** of Southeast Asia's VC activity.
- Record Year:** 2024 saw record-breaking deal flow, with growing interest from international investors.
- Key Sectors:**
 - Fintech:** Leading sector, especially in financial inclusion and digital banking.
 - Cleantech:** Gaining momentum.
 - Consumer Services & Logistics:** Driven by a young, consumption-driven population.
- Investment Challenges:**
 - MSMEs **face a significant funding gap** due to **limited access** to **traditional banking**.
 - Cultural barriers**, especially for women entrepreneurs, **hinder equity adoption**.
- Private Equity Activity:**
 - Firms like **Creador committed PHP20 billion over five years**, focusing on mid-market growth and financial inclusion.
 - M&A activity is expected to rise, especially in financial services, healthcare, and education.

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Other Factors Affecting Entrepreneurial Opportunity:

- Employment rates
- Government policies
- Trade issues

Example — Saudi Arabia:

- A newer driver of entrepreneurship includes a **high unemployment rate** with a **large percentage** of the **population** in its prime earning years.
- In the past, employment was **less of a concern** because of **dependency on state support** from **oil revenue**.
- More recently, the population has become **restless**, with a **desire to become productive** and have **greater control** over their own **resources** — and the rulers recognize that oil production income is volatile and unsustainable.

Factors That Promote Entrepreneurial Opportunities in a Country:

- **Independent thinking being encouraged**
 - Countries like the **United States** have **large populations** of immigrants and **few prescribed traditions** that encourage conformity, while other cultures emphasize political, cultural, and economic unity and place a strong value on not being noticed, blending in, and following prescribed habits and traditions.
- **Minimal bureaucracy**
 - Some countries have **complex bureaucracies** that **prevent quick responses** and place barriers to entrepreneurial activities.
- **Easy access to information inspiring creativity and open-mindedness**
 - Some cultures and bureaucracies may **prevent people from finding access to information necessary** for the successful advancement of an idea.
- **Transparency International** is an organization that tracks corruption, which can be an inhibitor to entrepreneurship.

Conditions that encourage creativity and innovation *(support for freedom to create and innovate):*

- **Acceptance of failure**
- **Ability** and **opportunity** to **connect** with other **people** to **discuss ideas, problems, challenges**, and **solutions**
- Role of the internet in **identifying** and **solving** problems around the world
- What we need is an **efficient** and **transparent** way to form companies and enable constructive competition, along with continued free and fair trade.

Reflection Questions:

- Consider your personal experiences.
- In what kind of environment do you thrive?
- Have you experienced failure? How did you move past it?
- Are you comfortable sharing ideas in an open exchange with others in an effort to encourage creativity and innovation?

Growth Through Entrepreneurial Education:

- More colleges and **universities** are teaching **entrepreneurial studies** and opening entrepreneurial centers.
- Some institutions **offer courses to prepare students for work** in the **gig economy** as the employment landscape evolves.
- Groups of students in different majors are now **collaborating to create ideas** that meet specific needs and challenges in today's world.
- Students from different universities around the globe are connecting to come up with business ideas to solve global problems.

Social Entrepreneur: identifies a problem with a **social or community focus**, a concern for quality of life, or concern for our entire planet's health.

- **Example:** Angad Daryani, a young inventor who joined the Media Lab at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) in the United States to work on an industrial-scale air filter to clean pollutants and carcinogens out of our planet's air.

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Daryani's home country of India is the world's third-largest emitter of carbon dioxide.

Serial Entrepreneur: someone who **starts** and **harvests multiple** entrepreneurial ventures.

- **Example:** Daryani is also a serial entrepreneur. His various ventures include:
 - **Sharkits** — a do-it-yourself-kit company that teaches children how to build technology
 - **SharkBot 3D Printer** — an attractive, low-cost, and reliable 3D printer

Module 2: Entrepreneurial Vision and Goals

2.1 Entrepreneurial Vision

Entrepreneurial vision can be defined as:

- The start of a road map that will determine where they want to go with their entrepreneurial efforts.
- What the entrepreneur wants the business to look like in the future.

Tools that can help define the entrepreneurial vision:

- **Vision statement** — what an entrepreneur wants the business to grow into.
- **Mission statement** — states what the venture will do, what value will be provided, and how it will be accomplished.
- **Value proposition** — a summary statement that conveys the benefits of the product or service provided to customers.

Think about this: What is your mission/vision?

- Visualize in your mind and let your imagination take control:
 - Where are you at this point? Where are you living, where are you working, and what are you doing with your life?
 - Now consider the following: Where do you see yourself in a couple of years? Do you see yourself working for someone else, or do you see yourself accomplishing great things as an entrepreneur?

- As an entrepreneur, what venture or problem do you see yourself solving?

How to begin writing down your entrepreneurial vision:

- Start with an outline and fill in the details later.
- Set aside time each day to work on it.
- If you experience a mental block, try changing your environment.
- Consider talking with someone who has experience in the industry to give you suggestions.
- Find a mentor in your area of interest — they can help you with ideas.

Finding a Mentor — key qualities to look for:

- Trust
- Respect
- Good listener

Benefits of Mentorships:

- Coaching and training
- Motivation and support
- Goals and achievements
- Advice and direction

4 Types of Mentors:

Mentor Type	Description
The Sales Mentor	A mentor who is killer at sales.
The Operations Guru	An operational mind walking through KPIs and leading indicators.
The Biz Dev Guru	Has a list of contacts rich and deep into your industry and possibly target verticals.
The Entrepreneur	A leader who has been through many of the same problems that you have, and will often walk you through war stories of how he got the job done.

Example: Miracle Messages

- **Kevin F. Adler and Miracle Messages**
 - Miracle Messages is a volunteer-based nonprofit organization with a goal of helping

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homeless people reconnect with loved ones.

- The vision for this organization includes building a vast network of volunteers and partnerships to stop homelessness and bring people together.

Entrepreneurial vision considerations:

- When the vision has a shorter timeline, such as five years, it could focus on a local problem or situation, and over time evolve into a broader vision that includes more diverse markets or populations.
- Your vision should inspire the people involved in your startup to support your venture.
- Make sure you understand the venture's industry, competition, and trends that are evolving or might evolve in the future.
- Ideally, the vision should be **insightful, bold, inspirational, and believable**, and it should be developed into a formal **vision statement**.

2.2 The Vision Statement

Creative Approaches of Developing Your Vision

- One approach to developing your vision is to **begin with the end in mind**.
 - What picture of your desired future do you have in mind?
 - How could this vision fit with the ideas you have of creating a successful venture?
 - The vision for your personal future should allow for the necessary resources to support the venture's future, just as the venture's future will provide for your personal future.

Creative Thinking Process (4 steps):

1. Preparation

- Gather information and collect ideas.
- Apply **divergent thinking** to generate as many ideas as possible, even those that don't seem logical.

2. Incubation

- Walk away from thinking about the activity.
- This allows your unconscious mind to continue to think about the activity, even though your conscious mind is busy doing other things.

3. Illumination

- This is the **aha! moment** when the answer often pops into our conscious minds, and we recognize how to proceed.

4. Verification

- This is when you will craft your vision statement or message, responding to the exercise in creative thinking.

Creative Thinking Tools:

● Brainstorming

- Requires that participants generate ideas around the desired topic without judgment.
- You can do this alone or with others, but including other people provides a greater variety of ideas, as one person's ideas might trigger another idea from someone else.

● Divergent Thinking

- This allows for more diverse ideas, which may not be associated with the identified topic.
- As much as we want to encourage divergent ideas, we also want to discourage any judgment around our ideas.

● Mind Mapping

- Here, you create an illustration on paper or a chalkboard.
- Write down the words that come to mind, then link those words together with lines in a diagram that shows how each word relates to the others. The idea is that one word can lead to another.

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- **Conducting Research**

- Create surveys and ask people questions about their experiences related to your idea.
- Find secondary data or case studies that focus on a few in-depth, similar areas of interest or perform your own case studies.

Achieving Balance

- An entrepreneur must wear many hats.
- Achieve balance in their lives between their dedication to growing their entrepreneurial venture and their personal life.

Career Entrepreneur: someone who takes on the daily management as the owner of the venture, accepting, and perhaps enjoying, the daily risks and rewards of managing and building the venture.

- **Example: Roxanne Quimby (Burt's Bees)**
 - Difficult decisions: relocation to meet the growth needs of the company.
 - Advancing an entrepreneurial idea into a successful venture can come at the expense of personal life goals.
- Career entrepreneurs need support from family and friends who accept that their attention and energy are required for the success of the venture. Many career entrepreneurs will find challenges in meeting the needs of the venture while maintaining a work-life balance.

• **Clearly defining your idea of success for your life, and for your venture, is an important step in achieving balance.**

- What are your priorities?
- What can you do to balance the success of your new venture, the success of your own life, and the success of your family?
- Considering that balancing all the roles that we have in life is a frustration point for many people, can you find an opportunity to create an entrepreneurial venture?

Steps for Achieving Balance:

- Consider the unique challenges entrepreneurs can face.
 - Learning curves, difficult decisions, meeting physical requirements
- Make time for self-care and emotional awareness to maintain emotional health.
 - To do this, schedule your time out, including time for breaks.
- Ask mentors for leadership advice and tactics.
- Being aware of your own strengths and weaknesses, as well as of your preferences and dislikes, will help you achieve and maintain balance in your life.

The Importance of Goals

SMART goals are well-structured and defined goals that are:

- **Specific:** should be precise rather than broad
- **Measurable:** should be able to test in some quantifiable way if the goal has been met
- **Achievable:** goal must be attainable, effort must be put forth
- **Relevant:** well suited for what you want to accomplish
- **Timely:** must have a defined deadline

Module 3: Entrepreneurial Mindset

3.1 Entrepreneurial Mindset

Types of Entrepreneurs (there are various kinds):

- **Innovators** — find new approaches, methods, or products
- **Creators** — make something new
- **Market makers** — innovate or reinvent their market
- **Expanders and scalers** — seek to expand on previously created methods, products, or processes

*Regardless of their differences, they have one thing in common: They are able to **identify an opportunity**, and **they choose to act on that opportunity**.*

Multiple opportunities for entrepreneurship exist:

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- Most business ventures are innovative variations of an existing idea that has spread across locations, such as restaurants.
 - **Example:** McDonald's
- Being aware of your surroundings and the encounters in your life can reveal multiple opportunities for entrepreneurship. You need to ask questions to find areas where improvements could be made.
 - **Examples:** Uber and Grab, or bike sharing app (US and Japan)

The entrepreneurial mindset is a way of life and the lens through which you see the world.

- It is an **awareness** and **focus** on **identifying an opportunity** through solving a problem, and a willingness to take action to advance that idea.
- The entrepreneurial mindset involves **forward thinking, planning ahead**, and continual **"what if" analyses**.
- This should allow you to see that anyone can become an entrepreneur.

3.2 Entrepreneurial Spirit and Passion

What does it mean to have an entrepreneurial spirit?

- A way of thinking
- Overcoming obstacles and meeting challenges
- A can-do attitude
- Presenting valuable and worthwhile ideas
- Thinking beyond established patterns and processes and simultaneously keeping in mind laws and regulations

Passion in Entrepreneurship

- You need passion to drive the business long-term and to cope with challenges.
- However, passion for the sake of passion isn't enough: Your passion needs to be informed by your venture's vision and mission.
- This will ensure the business stays on track.

Example: Airbnb — a passion for supporting individual rights to rent out unused space.

3.3 An Entrepreneurial Mindset in Your Discipline or Field

3.3.1 Entrepreneurial Opportunities

Within your industry of interest or area of study:

- What are the challenges that create frustration?
- How can these be turned into opportunities?

The Need for Open-Mindedness in Entrepreneurship

- Tried and tested products and processes can be formidable obstacles to new ideas.
- It's important to be open to new possibilities for success and failure.
- An entrepreneurial mindset includes **creativity, problem-solving skills**, and a **propensity for innovation** — open-mindedness supports this.
- Some innovations can lead to disruptions within the industry or even create a new industry.

Innovator's Dilemma

- **Disruptive technology** — technologies that, once introduced, displace established patterns, processes, and systems previously accepted as normal or accepted.
- They threaten the established way of doing things.
- They occur through identifying new and valuable processes and products.
- Do customers always know what they want, and should we always listen to them?
- **Example:** Airbnb

Steps for Achieving Balance:

- Consider the unique challenges entrepreneurs can face.
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- Find a **mentor** in your area of interest.

Work It Out: Finding a Mentor

Benefits of Mentorships:

- Coaching and training
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- Advice and direction
- Goals and achievements

Qualities to look for in a mentor:

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- **Mind Mapping** — Create an illustration on paper or a chalkboard. Write down words that come to mind, then link them with lines showing how each relates to the others — one word can lead to another.
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Market makers	Innovate or reinvent their market

Expanders and scalers Seek to expand on previously created methods, products, or processes

Regardless of their differences, they all share one thing in common: they are **able to identify an opportunity and choose to act on that opportunity**.

Multiple opportunities for entrepreneurship exist:

- Most business ventures are **innovative variations of an existing idea** that has spread across locations, such as restaurants.
 - Example: **McDonald's**
- Being aware of your surroundings and the encounters in your life can reveal multiple opportunities for entrepreneurship. You need to ask questions to find areas where improvements could be made.
 - Examples: **Uber and Grab**, or bike sharing apps (US and Japan)

Definition: The Entrepreneurial Mindset The **entrepreneurial mindset** is a way of life and the lens through which you see the world.

- It is an awareness and focus on **identifying an opportunity through solving a problem**, and a willingness to take action to advance that idea.
- It involves **forward thinking, planning ahead, and continual "what if" analyses**.
- This should allow you to see that **anyone can become an entrepreneur**.

3.2 Entrepreneurial Spirit and Passion

What does it mean to have an entrepreneurial spirit?

- A way of thinking
- Overcoming obstacles and meeting challenges
- A can-do attitude
- Presenting valuable and worthwhile ideas
- Thinking beyond established patterns and processes while simultaneously keeping in mind laws and regulations

Passion in Entrepreneurship

- You need **passion** to drive the business long-term and to cope with challenges.
- However, **passion for the sake of passion isn't enough**: your passion needs to be

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informed by your venture's vision and mission.

- This will ensure the business **stays on track**.
- **Example: Airbnb** — a passion for supporting individual rights to rent out unused space.

3.3 An Entrepreneurial Mindset in Your Discipline or Field

3.3.1 Entrepreneurial Opportunities

Within your industry of interest or area of study:

- What are the challenges that create **frustration**?
- How can these be turned into **opportunities**?

The Need for Open-Mindedness in Entrepreneurship

- **Tried and tested products and processes** can be formidable obstacles to new ideas.
- It's important to be **open to new possibilities** for success and failure.
- An entrepreneurial mindset includes **creativity, problem-solving skills, and a propensity for innovation** — open-mindedness supports this.
- Some innovations can lead to **disruptions** within the industry or even create a **new industry**.

The Innovator's Dilemma

- **Disruptive technology** — technologies that, once introduced, **displace established patterns, processes, and systems** previously accepted as normal.
- They **threaten the established way of doing things**.
- They occur through identifying **new and valuable processes and products**.
- Key question: **Do customers always know what they want, and should we always listen to them?**
- **Example: Airbnb**

Steps for Achieving Balance *(repeated for emphasis)*

- Consider the unique challenges entrepreneurs face: learning curves, difficult decisions, meeting physical requirements.
- Make time for self-care and emotional awareness — schedule breaks.

- Ask mentors for leadership advice and tactics.
- Be aware of your own strengths, weaknesses, preferences, and dislikes.